

Durably Sustainability Scan

Detailed methodology: EmpCo and EU Forced Labour Regulation lens

This document explains how Durably assesses sustainability claims in websites and internal company documents. The scan is designed as a first-pass claims-risk assessment. It helps identify wording that may be too broad, insufficiently substantiated, audience-inappropriate, or potentially contradicted by negative external stakeholder signals.

1. Scope of the assessment

The scan is not a full ESG rating, assurance engagement or legal opinion. It focuses on sustainability communication risk: what the company says, where the claim appears, whether the wording is specific and evidence-backed, and whether negative external stakeholder signals suggest the claim should be reviewed before reuse.

Assessment layer	What is assessed	Why it matters
Green claims	Environmental wording such as green, sustainable, climate neutral, eco, recyclable, circular, low impact, net zero, carbon neutral, labels, icons and future performance claims.	Consumer-facing environmental claims may trigger EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 scrutiny, especially when they are generic, absolute, offset-based, comparative or insufficiently specified.
Social claims	Claims on human rights, labour rights, forced labour, responsible sourcing, suppliers, living wage, diversity, inclusion, worker welfare, customer fairness and community impact.	Social claims can create overstatement risk when coverage, due diligence, grievance/remedy, traceability or outcome evidence is unclear. Forced-labour and product/supply-chain claims receive specific regulatory attention.
External stakeholder context	Negative media, NGO, union, regulator, court, complaint, investigation, enforcement or stakeholder criticism signals.	Only negative external stakeholder signals are retained. Company-owned policies, sustainability reports, supplier codes, corporate news and positive announcements are excluded from this section.

2. Regulatory lenses used

EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825

For consumer-facing environmental communication, the scan applies an EmpCo-style lens. This includes checks for generic environmental claims without clear specification, self-declared sustainability labels, product-level climate-neutrality or carbon-neutrality claims based on offsetting, broad environmental claims about the whole product or company when only one feature is improved, legal requirements presented as distinctive green benefits, unclear comparative claims, and future environmental performance claims without clear, objective, public and verifiable commitments.

EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015

For social and supply-chain claims, the scan applies a specific forced-labour lens when the wording suggests that products, imports, exports, suppliers or supply chains are free from forced labour or are fully traceable. Higher-risk wording should be supported by product and supplier traceability, forced-labour risk assessment, mitigation, grievance/remedy, escalation, withdrawal or customs-response readiness, and evidence of remediation where risks are identified.

3. Score calculation

The scan produces three scores: Global score, Green score and Social score. A higher score means higher claim-risk exposure. Scores are indicative and should be interpreted together with the claim evidence table and external stakeholder signals.

Score component	Weight	How the component is calculated
Claim wording risk	Approx. 34%	Assesses whether the wording is generic, absolute, future-oriented, comparative, label/icon-based, offset-related, forced-labour-related, supplier-control-related, or otherwise likely to create a broad expectation in the reader.
Evidence-gap risk	Approx. 32%	Assesses whether the scanned text provides scope, metrics, methodology, baseline, limits, verification, coverage, grievance/remedy, audit quality, traceability or implementation evidence. Missing evidence increases the score.
Negative external stakeholder context	Approx. 22%	Retains only negative stakeholder signals after excluding company-owned documents and positive/neutral news. Signals may include regulator action, complaints, lawsuits, NGO/union concerns, investigations, enforcement, controversy reporting or allegations.
Sector and channel sensitivity	Approx. 12%	Adjusts for sector exposure and communication channel. Consumer-facing claims receive stronger EmpCo relevance; investor/internal documents are mainly treated as evidence or consistency context unless reused in marketing.

Regulatory multipliers and safeguards

Specific regulatory indicators can raise the relevant dimension score. For green claims, this includes EmpCo blacklisted-practice indicators such as generic environmental claims, offset-based product neutrality claims, unverified labels and poorly specified comparative claims. For social claims, this includes forced-labour, modern-slavery, product traceability, import/export or supplier assurance wording that implies a level of control without adequate evidence. Sector exposure alone cannot create a high-risk result; it functions as a sensitivity modifier.

4. Interpretation of the three scores

Score	Interpretation
0-29	Low claim-risk signal. The wording appears relatively specific or no major high-risk signal was detected. Manual review remains recommended.
30-49	Potentially overbroad claim or limited substantiation. Check scope, evidence, channel and supporting documentation.
50-74	Medium to high concern. The claim may require reformulation, stronger evidence or legal/compliance review before reuse.
75-100	High-risk signal. This typically requires high-sensitivity wording plus significant evidence gaps, regulatory indicators or relevant negative stakeholder context.

5. Claim detection and source referencing

Each claim signal should be read as a traceable review item. The scan identifies the source page or document, extracts the relevant passage, marks the trigger words that caused the signal, and explains why the wording requires review.

Field in the report	Meaning
Where the claim was found	The page, document or link where the wording was detected. For websites this is normally the crawled URL or a related page; for uploaded documents it is the uploaded file.
Exact detected passage	The sentence or passage from the scanned material. This is the wording to verify manually. The scan avoids relying only on isolated keywords.
Problematic trigger words	Words or phrases within the passage that may create risk, for example generic, absolute, comparative, label/icon, climate-neutrality, supplier-control or forced-labour wording.
Why this matters	Explains the regulatory or substantiation concern, such as lack of scope, missing evidence, broad implied coverage or possible EmpCo/Forced Labour Regulation relevance.
Suggested improvement	A safer direction for reformulation: specific, scoped, evidenced, time-bound and transparent about limitations.

6. External stakeholder signals

This layer is deliberately narrow. It is not a general news feed. It is intended to capture negative stakeholder perceptions that may contradict, qualify or increase scrutiny of a sustainability claim. Positive news, corporate announcements and company-owned documents are excluded from this layer.

Included	Excluded
Negative media articles, NGO concerns, union statements, regulator decisions, consumer-authority actions, court cases, formal complaints, investigations, enforcement actions, allegations and controversy reporting.	Company sustainability reports, annual reports, ESG reports, policies, supplier codes, modern-slavery statements, corporate websites, investor relations pages, corporate press releases, product launches, partnerships, awards and other positive or neutral news.

7. Visual and icon review

The website scan also checks available HTML cues for potentially relevant visual signals, including alt text, file names, image titles, class names and labels. Examples include leaf icons, eco badges, planet imagery, recycled symbols and self-declared label-style claims. This is a first-pass screen only; a manual review of imagery, packaging, videos and dynamic pages remains necessary.

8. Limitations

The scan depends on accessible text, metadata and search results. It may miss claims embedded in images, videos, PDFs that cannot be parsed, dynamic webpages, paywalled sources or sources blocked from crawling. The result is an indicative screening signal only and should be verified by legal, compliance and subject-matter experts before external use.